

MIN-JONG BONG

Ph.D. Candidate in Inorganic Chemistry · Korea University · Advisor: Prof. Ho-Jin Son

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RESEARCH INTEREST

Ph.D. candidate in Inorganic Chemistry at Korea University (expected February 2027), specializing in the design of single-molecule Mn(I) catalysts for selective CO₂ reduction. Research centers on secondary coordination sphere engineering of well-defined molecular complexes — inspired by formate dehydrogenase enzymes — integrating experimental (operando FTIR, CV, XRD) and computational (DFT; ORCA) approaches with Python-based automation of computational workflows. Key results include a TON of ~300 with >94% formate selectivity, published in *Chemical Science* (2026, co-first author).

Keywords: Organometallic Synthesis, CO₂ Reduction, Photocatalysis, Secondary Coordination Sphere, Operando FTIR, DFT

EDUCATION

Ph.D. candidate, Inorganic Chemistry

Mar 2024 – Present

Korea University · Department of Advanced Materials Chemistry · Advisor: Prof. Ho-Jin Son

M.S., Inorganic Chemistry

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

Korea University · Department of Advanced Materials Chemistry · Advisor: Prof. Ho-Jin Son

B.S., Advanced Materials Chemistry

Mar 2018 – Feb 2022

Korea University (Sejong)

PUBLICATIONS

[1] A secondary-sphere proton channel accelerating metal-hydride formation in Mn(I) catalysts for selective CO₂-to-formate conversion

Min-Jong Bong[†], Wonjung Lee[†], Daehan Lee, Hyunuk Kim, Junhyeok Seo, Ho-Jin Son

Chemical Science · 2026 · *Royal Society of Chemistry* · DOI: 10.1039/D5SC09412G 

[2] Efficient and Durable Photochemical CO₂ Reduction by TiO₂-Immobilized Metal Porphyrin Catalysts

Hyeongu Kang, Daehan Lee, Sangheon Jeong, Seunghwan Cha, Min-Jong Bong, Myung Jae Lee, Won-Jo Jung, Ho-Jin Son

ChemSusChem, 19, e202501889 · 2026 · *Wiley-VCH / Chemistry Europe* · DOI: 10.1002/cssc.202501889

[3] Organic phosphorescence in Pt(II)-complexes linked to organic chromophores for blue-emitting organic light-emitting diodes

Seong Woon Jeong[‡], Hyung Joo Lee[‡], Bum June Park, Min-Jong Bong, Daehan Lee, Taekyung Kim, Chul Hoon Kim, Ho-Jin Son

Communications Chemistry, 8, 140 · 2025 · *Nature Portfolio* · DOI: 10.1038/s42004-025-01533-y

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Tether Length Modulation of Secondary Coordination Layer

2024 – Present

Systematic variation of –OH/–OMe pendant length at 6,6'-bipy positions of Mn(I) complexes. Best performer Mn-DiMeOMe: TON 368, formate selectivity 97.8%.

Photocatalysis · CV · Operando FTIR · DFT · XRD

Proton Relay Engineering in Mn(I) Complexes

2022 – 2025

Ethylene-bridged pendants mimic formate dehydrogenase. Mn-bpydiOMe: TON ~300, formate selectivity >94%. Published in Chem. Sci. 2026.

CO₂ Reduction · Operando FTIR · DFT · Mechanistic Study

SKILLS & METHODS

Technical:	Organic & organometallic synthesis, Glovebox & Schlenk techniques, Air-sensitive compound handling, Photocatalysis, 3D Graphic Design (Adobe Dimension)
Instrumental:	Operando FTIR, Cyclic Voltammetry, UV-Vis Spectroscopy, Quantum Yield Measurement, Single-crystal XRD, Structure refinement (SHELXTL/SHELXL), NMR, ESI-MS, GC-MS, GC-TCD, HPLC
Computational:	DFT (ORCA, Gaussian), CPCM solvation, Reaction pathway mapping, Python (computational data automation & visualization), AI-assisted computational workflow (Claude Code)

TEACHING & MENTORING

General Chemistry Laboratory 1 Lecturer

Spring 2026

Serving as course instructor for general chemistry laboratory.

CURT Undergraduate Research Mentoring

Feb – Jul 2024

Mentored undergraduates in research design and execution.

General Chemistry Laboratory 1 TA

Spring 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Supervised lab sessions for general chemistry.

General Chemistry Laboratory 2 TA

Fall 2022, 2024

Supervised lab sessions for general chemistry.

Inorganic Chemistry Laboratory TA

Fall 2023, 2024, 2025

Instructed inorganic synthesis experiments.

HONORS & AWARDS

Excellence in Poster Presentation Award

2025

Inorganic Chemistry Division, Korean Chemical Society

Second Coordination Sphere Engineering for Efficient and Selective CO₂-to-Formate Conversion of Mn(I) Bipyridyl Complexes: Steric and Brønsted Acidity/Basicity Influence of Alcohol and Alkyloxy Pendants and Its Mechanistic Investigation

Excellent Research Award

2021

CURT Research Program, Korea University

A Hybrid Ru/TiO₂ Catalyst for Photocatalytic CO₂ to CO/Formate Conversion